

Worksheet 3: ERP Practice Log

Name: _____ Session/Date: _____ Clinician: _____

This log is used during Exposure and Response Prevention (ERP). Each practice means: face a rung from your ladder and stay with the distress WITHOUT doing the compulsion or avoidance, until the distress begins to come down on its own or you learn the feared outcome does not occur. Start low; increase gradually.

Begin each session with a brief safety check. If risk is elevated, pause ERP and address safety first. Higher-risk exposures are done with clinician guidance and appropriate safeguards.

Why this works (reminders)

- The thought is not the danger - it is a thought the brain flags by mistake.
- The compulsion/avoidance is what keeps the fear alive.
- Staying with the thought and doing nothing teaches the brain it is safe.
- Distress comes down on its own - I do not have to fix it.

Before the practice

Safety check done? Yes / No OK to proceed? Yes / No

Rung I am practising today: _____

Type: In-vivo / Imaginal (circle)

Compulsions/avoidance I will HOLD BACK: _____

Safe coping skill if needed: _____

During the practice - track distress

Rate SUDS (0-100) at the start and every few minutes while staying with it. The goal is not a fast drop - it is to STAY without the reaction and observe what actually happens.

Time point	SUDS (0-100)	Did I do any reaction? (what?)
Start		
+ few min		
+ few min		
+ few min		
+ few min		
End		

Highest SUDS reached: _____ Lowest by the end: _____

After the practice - what I learned

What did I fear would happen, and what actually happened?

What does this tell me about the thought?

Between-session practice (homework)

Repeat agreed rungs on your own. Supporters should stay calm and NOT provide reassurance.

Day	Rung practised	Start SUDS	End SUDS	Reaction resisted? (Y/N)
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

Moving up the ladder

Move to the next rung only when the current one drops to roughly half its starting SUDS and feels much easier across several practices. Record the date each rung is 'graduated'.

Rung	First SUDS	Now feels like	Graduated (date)

If distress becomes unmanageable or any thoughts of self-harm arise: stop the exposure, use the safe coping skill, and contact your clinician or a crisis line. Slowing down is allowed and is not failure.